Martin Fankhauser
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Dear Dr. Deyo and Members of the Search Committee,

I am applying for the Assistant Professor of Economics position in Macro Economics and AI at San José State University. I am completing my PhD in Economics at Bocconi University, with graduation expected in 2027. My research develops econometric methods for identification, robust inference, and forecasting, with applications to macroeconomics.

My job market paper, *Sharp Identification for Regressions with Interval-Observed and Missing Covariates*, joint with Gil Peled, characterizes sharp identified sets for conditional moment models when variables are missing or observed through intervals. We develop estimation and inference without assuming random missingness. An application shows that obtaining a sharp rather than an outer set can change the substantive conclusion drawn from the data.

My other work brings this interest in robust conclusions to macroeconomics. In my sole-authored *Robust Bayesian Inference under Partially Specified Priors*, I develop methods that use economically meaningful but incomplete prior information in structural models. In *Power Prior for VARs*, joint with Massimiliano Marcellino and Tommaso Tornese, we borrow cross-country data in Bayesian VARs to improve forecasting and structural inference while retaining conjugacy. My sole-authored *Conformal Quantile Nowcasting* turns point forecasts into inexpensive quantile nowcasts using past real-time forecast errors; its GDP application focuses on downside risk. Together, these projects motivate further work on reliable macroeconomic forecasting with large and changing information sets.

At Bocconi, I have delivered lectures and problem sessions in PhD microeconometrics and macroeconometrics over four academic years and served as a teaching assistant in undergraduate econometrics and master's-level big-data econometrics. My lectures include high-dimensional methods, Bayesian statistics, and structural VARs. I would welcome teaching undergraduate macroeconomics and econometrics, graduate forecasting, and applied projects using economic data.

SJSU's commitment to institutional excellence and student success speaks to how I teach. To support students with different levels of preparation, I explain difficult ideas step by step and connect derivations to simulations and examples. After feedback that I moved too quickly, I covered less per session and made more time for questions and exercises. At SJSU, I would continue to seek feedback, offer structured practice, and support students from different backgrounds as they develop confidence in quantitative work.

I would welcome the opportunity to contribute to SJSU's teaching and research community, mentor students, and pursue research collaborations. Thank you for considering my application.

Yours sincerely,

Martin Fankhauser